The Islamic Dilemma is no dilemma

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The argument, in five lines

1. **P1.** The Qur'an confirms the Torah and the Gospel.
2. **P2.** The Torah and the Gospel are the Bible Jews and Christians hold.
3. **P3.** That Bible teaches what Islam rejects: the cross, divine sonship, the Trinity.
4. **P4.** So either the Qur'an contradicts itself, or it confirmed a corrupted book.
5. **C.** Either way, Islam fails.

Four words it changes

WORD	IN THE ARGUMENT	IN THE QUR'AN AND THE SOURCES
"Gospel"	The four Gospels	*al-Injīl* is always singular: the revelation given to Jesus. The four-Gospel canon was argued for by Irenaeus around 180 CE.
"Torah"	The whole Old Testament	*al-Tawrāh* is singular: the revelation given to Moses.
"Confirm"	Guarantees the text	*Taṣdīq* attests truth. Jesus "confirms the Torah" and changes some of its law Q 3:50.
"People of the Book"	Holders of one fixed Bible	No such Bible existed: the Syriac Christians of Arabia read a 22-book New Testament, and the canons still differ.

The Qur'an's own position

The Qur'an says three things, and they fit together: God revealed the Torah and the Gospel; their communities were *entrusted* with them and forgot, hid or misread part Q 5:14 · 2:75; and the Qur'an is *muhaymin*, guardian and arbiter over what survives Q 5:48. The dilemma offers two options. The Qur'an holds a third.

وَأَنزَلْنَا إِلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ مُصَدِّقًا لِّمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ وَمُهَيْمِنًا عَلَيْهِ

"We have sent down the Book to you with the truth, confirming what was before it and as guardian over it." Q 5:48

Verses, answered in a line

VERSE	CITED FOR	THE ANSWER
Q 5:47	Christians must judge by their Gospel	"By what God revealed therein", in a passage about legal judgment, followed at once by *muhaymin*.
Q 5:68	"Uphold the Torah and the Gospel"	A call to consistency, ending with the warning that the Qur'an will increase many in rebellion.
Q 10:94	The Prophet told to ask Christians	A conditional about doubt he did not have; the commentators say it concerned converts such as ʿAbdullāh ibn Salām.
Q 18:27 · 6:115	"None can change His words"	The first is about the Qur'an, the second God's decrees. Neither speaks of earlier texts.
Q 15:9	God guards His scripture	It speaks of the Qur'an. Earlier books were "entrusted" **Q 5:44**.
Q 29:46	"We believe in what was revealed to you"	Belief in the original revelation, not a guarantee of every manuscript.
Q 3:84	"No distinction between any of them"	About prophets, not texts **Q 4:150**.

The record, in a line each

- **Classical scholars.** Most located *taḥrīf* in meaning, read the Bible through the Qur'an, and quoted what agreed with it (Adang, Michel, Schaffner). The verb *yuḥarrifūna* is used four times, only of certain Jews.
- **Hebrew Bible.** The Dead Sea Scrolls show several forms of the text before 70 CE: Isaiah with 2,600 differences, Jeremiah one-eighth shorter in Greek, a lost paragraph of Samuel, Gerizim for Ebal at Deut 27:4 (Tov).
- **New Testament.** The longer ending of Mark, John 7:53–8:11 and 1 John 5:7 were added later; 1 Tim 3:16, Heb 2:9 and John 1:18 are disputed (Metzger, Ehrman).
- **Paul.** No prophet came between Jesus and Muhammad **Bukhārī 3442 · Muslim 2365**, so Paul's letters carry no scriptural authority in Islam.
- **Forgiveness.** The Qur'an says no soul bears another's burden **Q 53:38**; so say Deut 24:16, Ezek 18:20 and Ps 51:16–17, against Heb 9:22.

Five questions to ask in return

1. Which Bible, in which language, with which canon?
2. Where does the Qur'an accuse the Christians of forging the text, as against forgetting it **Q 5:14**?
3. Do you apply the same textual criticism to 1 John 5:7 as you do to Muslim proof-texts?
4. How do you establish Paul's authority without citing Paul?
5. What would change your mind?

Based on Mohd Elfie Nieshaem Juferi, *Reconsidering the "Islamic Dilemma"* (Kuala Lumpur, 2026), free at academia.edu/166160379. Verses, hadith and sources are checked on islamicdilemma.info; the full case, with every reference, is at **islamicdilemma.info/muslim-response/**. Qur'an quotations are translations of the Arabic. Bible quotations: ESV.